Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Comprehensive Guide for Districts

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Introduction

This comprehensive guide provides Michigan school districts with structured administrative guidelines for implementing responsible AI practices across organizational roles, policy, and operations. It offers practical examples and templates to help district leaders establish clear guardrails of AI use in teaching and learning, and to integrate AI readiness for staff and students into Michigan Integrated Continuous Improvement Process (MICIP) cycles. By following these guidelines, administrators may help support safe, equitable, and effective AI use while maintaining educator oversight, protecting student privacy, and fostering transparency with stakeholders.

As AI continues to evolve, districts may find value in gradually developing the knowledge, systems, and safeguards that help support thoughtful and effective use of these tools. When integrated in ways that align with local priorities, AI has the potential to enhance instructional practices, streamline operations, and expand the capacity of staff to meet the diverse needs of students and the broader school community.

Essential Practices to Consider

- **Keep AI Purposeful and Safe**
  Districts may consider using AI to support learning and operations in ways that align with district goals and educational priorities.
- **Protect Privacy and Integrity**
  - Districts should be aware of and follow federal privacy and accessibility laws.
    - Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) - Follow federal requirements for protecting students' education records. Useful resources include the U.S. Department of Education's FERPA overview and technical assistance tools.
    - Children's Online Privacy Protection Act (COPPA) - For online tools and applications used with children under 13, ensure parental consent and proper data collection practices, following the Federal Trade Commission's COPPA FAQs: COPPA compliance guide.
    - Accessibility - Meet digital accessibility requirements under Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973 (29 U.S.C. § 794**)**, Title II under the American With Disabilities Act of 1990, and Section 508 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, as amended (29 U.S.C. 794d). 29 U.S.C. 794d).

- See the U. S. Department of Education's guidance for making educational technology inclusive: Technology accessibility requirements.
  - Districts may encourage staff and students to document when and how AI tools are used (e.g., in assignments) to support academic integrity and transparency.
    - **Build AI Literacy for All**
      Districts may consider offering computer science concepts, such as algorithms, data, and computational thinking, that form the foundational knowledge needed to fully develop AI literacy.
    - **Maintain Human Oversight**
      AI can assist, but not replace, educators or decision-makers. Districts may choose to review tools for bias, accuracy, and appropriateness prior to adoption.
    - **Promote Equity and Accessibility**
      Districts may assess whether AI tools effectively support diverse learners and provide necessary accommodations to promote equitable access.
    - **Support Transparency and Continuous Improvement**
      Districts may communicate openly with stakeholders and regularly review AI practices through continuous improvement processes, such as MICIP cycles (needs assessment → plan → implement → monitor → evaluate).

Phase 0 (Pre-Launch, Weeks 0–6): Organize and Listen

Team Structure and Roles

Districts may consider:

- Designating a district AI lead. This might be the curriculum director, chief information officer, chief technology officer, or data privacy officer.
- Creating a diverse AI working group. This should include teachers, admins, students/families, technology staff, and special education representatives.
- Setting a communication cadence. This should include biweekly meetings and/or monthly updates to the board and/or cabinet.

Landscape and Listening

Districts may consider:

- Running a baseline AI landscape scan (current staff use, student use, tools, and frequency of use). Examples include:
  - Project Tomorrow AI in K-12 Survey

    - AI Education Project (aiEDU) Student and Teacher Readiness Rubrics (download needed)
    - Michigan Virtual Teacher Readiness for Implementing Generative AI
- Using School and District Readiness Rubrics to self-assess strengths/gaps. Examples include:
    - aiEDU School and District Readiness Rubrics (download needed)
    - Consortium for School Networking (CoSN) K12 Gen AI Readiness Checklist
- Exploring tools for evaluating meaningful learning with technology resources. Examples include:
    - Triple E (Engage, Enhance, Extend) Framework
    - Technological, Pedagogical Content Knowledge (TPACK)
- Having the technology department inventory/register AI systems, owners, data, risk, etc. Examples include:
    - CoSN K-12 Gen AI Maturity Tool (download needed)
    - National Institute of Standards in Technology (NIST) AI Risk Management Framework (RMF)
    - Algorithmic Impact Assessment (AIA) Tool for moderate/high-risk use cases
- Exploring and evaluating a range of AI toolkits to find the best match for the district's needs based upon the baseline AI landscape scan and surveys that were conducted. Examples include:
    - Michigan Virtual Admin Guide to AI
    - TeachAI Toolkit
    - Common Sense Media AI Toolkit

Suggested Deliverables (Phase 0)

District may consider creating:

- A document that identifies roles, meeting cadence, decision rights, etc. for the AI workgroup.
- An AI inventory spreadsheet with rubric scores to identify use and gaps in familiarity with AI tools.
- A draft update of the acceptable use policy (AUP) for staff and student use of AI.

Phase 1 (Weeks 7–12): Guardrails, Policy, MICIP Alignment

Policy and Board Readiness Considerations

Districts may consider:

- Drafting a model board policy.
- Drafting a superintendent memo. To share with whom?
- Drafting a board resolution.
- Updating the staff AUP and the student AUP
- Adding human oversight clauses to relevant policies—no high-stakes decisions by AI without documented human review and appeal.

Compliance and Risk Controls

Districts may consider:

- Aligning organizational practices to NIST AI Risk Management Framework (RMF).
- Having an AI team review compliance with:
  - FERPA
  - COPPA
  - Children's Internet Protection Act (CIPA)
  - Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA)/K12 Security Information Exchange (SIX) cybersecurity baseline.

MICIP Integration (Continuous Improvement)

Districts may consider:

- Adding AI readiness indicators and goals to MICIP needs assessment/plan.
- Planning quarterly monitoring checkpoints aligned to MICIP monitoring.

Suggested Deliverables (Phase 1)

Districts may consider creating:

- A draft board policy, memo, resolution, or a board agenda item (example – Ann Arbor AI Bill of Rights).
- An updated AUP for staff and students.
- Entries in the district MICIP plan that include needs assessment, root cause, challenge statement, goals, interim and end targets, strategy, implementation, monitoring, and funding alignment.

Phase 2 (Weeks 13–24): Classroom Practice, Professional Learning, Procurement

Instructional Guardrails and Considerations

Districts may consider:

- Posting classroom AI norms (student disclosure, privacy, verification, fairness, age-appropriate use). Examples include:
  - Guidance on the Use of AI in Our Schools by TeachAI
  - Teacher Guide to Artificial Intelligence in Education by Michigan Virtual
  - Student Guide to Artificial Intelligence in Education by Michigan Virtual
- Adding student and educator AI competency frameworks (grade-band progression K–5, 6–8, 9–12) to curriculum maps. Examples include:
  - AiEDU Student and Educator Readiness Competency Rubrics
  - Empowering Learners for the Age of AI: An AI Literacy Framework for Primary and Secondary Education
  - AI4K12.org Grade Progression Charts
  - AI competency framework for teachers by UNESCO
- Offering or developing academic integrity guidance when using AI - such as requesting process evidence (drafts, reflections, oral defenses). Examples include:
  - Guidance on the Use of AI in Our Schools by TeachAI
  - Academic integrity in the age of AI by Turnitin

Professional Learning

Many education organizations offer professional learning on AI topics; however, an opportunity supported through MDE grant funds is available for media and AI literacy trainer cohorts. This program provides ready-to-use agendas and slide decks that trainers can bring back to their districts and use to support staff learning. Associations participating in this work include:

- Regional Educational Media Centers (REMC)
- Michigan Association for Computer Users in Learning (MACUL)
- Michigan Virtual
- Michigan Association of School Librarians (MASL)

Districts may access more information about this opportunity on the Michigan Department of Education Artificial Intelligence webpage.

Professional Learning Community (PLC) Commitment

Districts may consider utilizing PLCs to explore where AI literacy connects to classroom learning opportunities. The following resources may help support these discussions in ways that align with local goals and instructional priorities:

- PLCs may explore classroom activities or assignments that support appropriate student AI literacy using the Michigan K-12 AI Learning Alignment Framework - Computer Science.
- PLCs may consider developing classroom activities or assignments based on the Classroom-level Matrix and Implementing AI: A Practical Guide for the Classroom to encourage thoughtful and appropriate use of AI in each classroom.

Procurement and Vendor Due Diligence

Districts may consider updating a request for proposal template to include an expanded vendor questionnaire covering AI-specific requirements. This may include:

- Model cards: model cards provide standardized documentation that describes an AI model's intended use, training data sources, performance, limitations, and known risks. Model cards help the district verify whether a vendor's AI system is appropriate, transparent, and safe for district use.
- Data sources and licensing: information on where AI model training data originated, whether it is lawfully obtained, and whether it includes proprietary or sensitive material.
- Privacy terms: how data is stored, protected, and used within the system.
- Data retention and deletion policies: how long the system retains data, and the processes for securely deleting it.
- Accessibility: compliance with federal and state accessibility standards.
- Attribution: mechanisms for indicating when AI is used to generate or alter content.
- Monitoring, drift detection, and drift control processes: methods used to identify when the AI model's performance degrades over time due to changes in real-world data, and the vendor's procedures for correcting or retraining the model to maintain accuracy and reliability.
- Right to audit provisions: the district's ability to review vendor practices, documentation, and controls to ensure compliance.

Districts may consider utilizing AI tool evaluations. Here are examples of AI tool evaluation resources:

- Rubric-for-AI-Tool-Evaluation-In-Depth
- Rubric for Evaluating AI Tools: Fundamental Criteria

Suggested Deliverables (Phase 2)

Districts may consider creating:

- Classroom norms posters/handouts. Examples include:
  - Setting AI Expectations by Common Sense Media
  - AI Guidance for Schools Toolkit by Teach AI
  - Classroom AI Use Agreement Template by Educators Technology
  - AI Classroom Policy Teacher Guide by Educators Technology
  - Dos and Don'ts of AI in the Classroom by the National Education Association
  - AI Classroom Assignment Norms Tool by Kapor Foundation
  - Unlocking Generative AI Safely and Responsibly Toolkit by Cyberlite and Microsoft
- PD materials, including a cohort calendar or sample lesson plans.
- Updated procurement documents and contract clauses.

Phase 3 (Weeks 25–36): Classroom AI Implementation, Community Engagement and Board Adoption

Instructional Implementation

Districts may consider:

- Having teachers model appropriate use of AI to support and enhance student learning.
- Having teachers identify gaps in available support and provide feedback on needed improvements to AI guidance and professional learning.

Transparency

Districts may consider adding an annual AI transparency report to their Annual Education Report that includes information on AI inventory, incidents, outcomes, improvements, the retirement of ineffective tools, and contracts.

Community Communications

Districts may consider:

- Posting a short, plain-language parent/community notice and frequently asked questions (FAQ) in multiple languages.

- Holding an informational session at each school district building that addresses AI appropriately for grade levels at that building.
- Sharing on the district website what the district will/won't do regarding AI privacy, human oversight, and age safeguards.

Board Action

Districts may consider:

- Presenting the 2nd reading of the finalized AI Guidance/Policy for adoption. Suggested items may include AI implementation model, AI inventory progress, PD status, procurement updates, and MICIP alignment.
- Publishing the policy and implementation plan on the district website if adopted by the board of education.

Suggested Deliverables (Phase 3)

Districts may consider creating:

- A board presentation for parents and community members, which could include the following components: policy pillars, AI implementation model, classroom guardrails, procurement, MICIP alignment, timeline, and measures.
- An adopted policy and resolution posted on the district website.
- An AI transparency report that includes items such as inventory, incidents, outcomes, improvements, a process to retire ineffective tools, and contract review cadence.

Phase 4 (Weeks 37-52): Evaluate, Report, Iterate (MICIP Cycle)

Evaluation and Monitoring

Districts may consider:

- Running reviews on appropriate AI classroom use cases and collecting classroom evidence with a focus on accuracy, bias, accessibility, and teacher feedback.
- Analyzing appropriate AI classroom evidence for improvement actions.
- Monitoring AI readiness indicators in MICIP monitoring and adjusting the plan quarterly.

Suggested Deliverables (Phase 4)

Districts may consider:

- Creating AI use cases.
- Creating improvement actions based on AI use cases.
- Analyzing AI transparency report.
- Updating MICIP entries.

Potential AI Implementation Measures of Success

- Instructional impact: Teacher adoption/feedback, student outcomes tied to AI-supported strategies
- Equity and accessibility: Reduction of barriers, accommodations satisfied, fairness checks documented
- Privacy and security: Zero advertising/secondary uses, incident rates, AIA completion for risk (if used)
- AI implementation maturity: Inventory accuracy, policy adherence, MICIP indicators trending positively

Artificial Intelligence (AI) Use Disclosure: Microsoft CoPilot was used to check the grammar and flow of this document. It was reviewed, edited, and fact-checked by a human editor(s) prior to publication.